SEO ARCADE · PODCASTING FOR BUSINESS TOOLKIT

Podcasting for business: the SEO field guide

How a podcast earns links, citations and content for a business, whether you host a show or guest on other people's. Built from 650+ episodes on the Unscripted podcast network.

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A podcast appearance is a citation

Most people think of a podcast as audio. Search engines and AI assistants see something else: a brand mention, a named expert, and a fresh page that links back to you. One recorded conversation shows up as a show-notes page, as listings across dozens of podcast directories, as a YouTube video, and as a recap article on the guest's own site.

> *"A podcast appearance is an SEO event. It absolutely is."*
>
> Jason Wade, Ninja AI, on the Unscripted SEO podcast

That is the whole case in one line. Each episode is a small, relevant web of pages that names you, describes what you know, and links to where you do business. Bought links are about whatever the seller had. Podcast links are about the topic you just spent 40 minutes talking about.

What we can say from our own network

The Unscripted network has published more than 650 episodes across 12 shows on Castos (count pulled 10 Nov 2026). Every episode gets a show-notes page with links, a YouTube upload, and a recap article. That volume is where the rules in this guide come from. Where something is our judgement and not a measurement, it says so.

Five jobs one show does for a business

Tom Fox, who runs the Compliance Podcast Network, gave five reasons every business should have a podcast when he came on Unscripted Small Business. Paraphrased:

Job	What it looks like in practice
Thought leadership	Your name sits next to the topics you want to be known for, on pages you did not have to write.
Client development	An interview invitation gets answered when a sales email does not. Prospects make great guests.
Audience engagement	Listeners spend 30 to 60 minutes with you. No blog post gets that.
Sales	Episodes answer objections in a real voice. Sales teams send them ahead of calls.
Marketing collateral	Clips, quotes, articles and newsletter sections all come from the same recording.

Read the full conversation: Tom Fox on podcasting as the most powerful content engine in SEO.

Host or guest: pick the faster win first

Guesting is faster. You borrow the host's audience, your name gets indexed across their distribution, and you earn a link without publishing anything yourself. Hosting is slower and compounds harder. You own the pages, the guest list and the relationships.

	Guest on other shows	Host your own show
Time to first link	Days to weeks after the episode airs	From the first episode, on your own domain
What you control	Your talking points and your recap post	Topics, guests, show notes, every internal link
Effort	About an hour per interview plus prep	Booking, recording, editing, publishing, promotion
Best for	Consultants, founders, anyone who needs authority now	Brands that want a content engine and a guest pipeline

If you host, decide what the show is for before episode one:

> *"Is this an interview show because this show is intended to be a connector? Or is this a show where I, as the owner, am positioning myself as the authority and I'm really elevating my face and my voice and I'm boosting this personal brand?"*
>
> Virginia Elder, Podcast Abundance, on Unscripted SEO

A connector show grows faster because every guest promotes it:

> *"If you want to grow your show, the fastest way to do it is to have guests. That's the fastest way. Why? Well, because the guest is going to promote your show as well because they're on the show."*
>
> Cahill Camden, on Unscripted SEO

More from guests and booking agents: podcast guesting strategy from 8 guests and podcast lead generation from 8 hosts.

One episode, eight SEO assets

Most shows publish the audio and stop. That leaves most of the value on the floor. This is the list we work from on every Unscripted episode. The SOP in this toolkit walks through each step.

1. **Show-notes page with links.** Guest site, the topics discussed, your own service pages. Spread links through the text, not in a block at the bottom.
2. **Directory syndication.** Your host pushes the feed to Apple, Spotify and the long tail of podcast directories. Each one is another page naming the guest and the show.
3. **Video upload.** The full episode on YouTube, with its own title and description.

4. **Two subject articles.** Built from what was actually said, with internal links to the pages you want to rank.
5. **Guest recap post.** A ready-to-publish article for the guest's site that links back to the episode and your articles.
6. **Clips and quote cards.** Short vertical video and quote images for social, each pointing back to the article.
7. **Transcript and quotes.** Real expert lines to drop into service pages and older posts.
8. **Syndication and newsletter.** Shorter recaps on LinkedIn, Substack and Reddit where they fit, plus a newsletter section.

A trap we measured on our own feed: Castos pushes show notes straight into the YouTube description, and YouTube caps descriptions at 5,000 characters. Castos cuts anything longer, so links sitting at the bottom of long show notes vanish from the video. In August 2026, 60 of 431 episodes on our SEO show were over our 4,500-character budget. Keep show notes under 4,500 characters and put the most important link in the first 500.

A 90-day plan to launch

Weeks	Host track	Guest track
1-2	Pick the show's job (connector or authority). Name it. Set up hosting, cover art and a recording tool.	Write a one-paragraph bio, 3 talk topics and a headshot. Build a list of 30 relevant shows.
3-4	Book 6 guests before you record. Start with people you already know.	Pitch 10 shows a week. Lead with a topic, not your résumé.
5-8	Record weekly. Publish each episode with show notes, an article and a guest recap.	Record. Send each host a recap article they can publish, with your links in it.
9-12	Add clips, quote cards and a newsletter. Review what earned links.	Track which appearances produced links and calls. Double down on those shows' neighbors.

Most shows die early. Cahill Camden put it plainly on Unscripted SEO: most people stop podcasting three to 10 episodes in. Plan for 12 before you judge it.

How to measure it without fooling yourself

- **Links, by URL.** Log every page that links to you from an episode: show notes, guest recap, directory pages. Store the URL, not a yes/no.
- **Branded search.** Watch impressions for your name and brand in Google Search Console, month over month.
- **AI citations.** Ask ChatGPT, Perplexity and Gemini who the experts on your topic are. Save the answers each month.
- **Booked calls.** Put a booking link on every episode page and tag it so you know which episode sent the call.
- **Guest republish rate.** How many guests actually published the recap you gave them.

One caveat from our own data: Search Console under-reports clicks, so treat it as a floor, not the full count. The checklist spreadsheet in this toolkit has a tab for each of these.

Podcasting for business, done for you

Everything in this guide is what we run every week on the Unscripted network. If you would rather have a show produced for you, or get booked as a guest on the right shows, that is what Podcasting As An SEO Service does.

Book a 30-minute podcast strategy call with Jeremy: **tidycal.com/unscriptedpodcasts/podcast-process**

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